Vitamins and minerals

Supplementation of vitamins is needed to replenish liver stores and repair tissue damage. The important vitamins are pyridoxine, cyanocobalamin, folate, niacin and thiamine. Supplementation of minerals such as calcium, magnesium and zinc should be given in adequate doses. Restriction of sodium is essential if ascites is present. Sodium restriction up to 500mg per day is seen with ascites. Low sodium foods should be encouraged.

Fibre

Adequate fibre can be given for the patient. In severe cases of cirrhosis, low fibre diet is necessary.

Fluid

Restricted fluid is given if ascites is present. The fluid requirement is 1500ml per day. If the ascites is corrected, normal fluid intake may be emphasized.

Foods to be included and avoided for Cirrhosis

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
• Bread, rice, maize, jowar, breakfast cereals, pasta and refined cereals	• Fried and fatty foods.
• Tonned milk and milk products like paneer and curd	• Fats, Oils
• Split pulses and beans	• Nuts and Oilseeds
• Sugar, jaggery, honey, jam or jellies	• Strongly flavoured vegetables
• Lean meat, egg white, fish or chicken	
• Potato, sweet potato, yam	
• Beverages, fruit juices	

HEPATIC ENCEPHALOPATHY!

Hepatic encephalopathy is a damage of brain and nervous system that occurs as a complication of liver disorders. Hepatic encephalopathy is characterized by neurological disturbances, elevated ammonia levels (ammonia which is not converted to urea by liver), high blood concentration of aromatic amino acids and low levels of branched chain amino acids.

The symptoms of hepatic encephalopathy are mild confusion, euphoria or depression, decreased attention, irritability, disturbance in sleep patterns, lethargy, speech disorientation, and finally coma.

Restriction of dietary protein is the first step. The diet should be rich in calories, low protein (BCAA protein can be given) and restricted fluid. Electrolyte imbalance should be corrected and vitamin supplementation especially vitamin B and C may be given

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